

Chapter 190 - Part 1

Extra 12-1

When Gu Yixue returned home, it was already eleven o'clock.

Originally, she didn't need to come home.

Once a movie started filming, she was the type to stay on set, with sleeping time pitifully short, usually around three to four hours.

But today was an exception.

She didn't know if anyone still remembered—today was her birthday.

Probably no one remembered.

Who would remember an unimportant person's birthday?

She rarely told others about her birthday.

Not to mention many people disliked illegitimate daughters, even she herself disliked her own origins.

But sometimes heaven played tricks, and fate was occasionally unfair.

She couldn't choose her own birth.

On her birthday, her mother passed away.

Also on her birthday, she returned to the Gu family.

So she didn't like celebrating birthdays.

Everyone in the Gu family only remembered Gu Chunmian's birthday, holding extravagant birthday parties for Gu Chunmian's birthday.

Gu Chunmian would call friends together, becoming the focus of everyone's attention.

And she was just Gu Chunmian's foil.

Or rather, a reference point.

But what disappointed everyone was that Gu Yixue didn't grow up the way everyone expected.

Everyone hoped she would be mediocre and accomplish nothing, but she had a rebellious streak. Even as a Beta, she was no worse than any Alpha or Omega.

After entering the Gu family, she never learned how to hide her sharp edges.

Every exam, she did better than Gu Chunmian.

Even her appearance far surpassed Gu Chunmian's.

Everyone said she resembled her mother.

Because her mother had once been an extremely popular actress, but she happened to meet her father.

Gu Yixue didn't have many memories of her mother anymore.

She only remembered that she was very beautiful.

Even now, people would still mention her mother's film and television works, reminiscing about that era that once briefly belonged to her mother. But she always avoided it.

She was unwilling to hear anything related to her mother.

Yet she diligently fulfilled her mother's last wish.

Her mother wanted to enter the Gu family genealogy, wanted her to live in the Gu family without 争 or 抢¹.

So she did as told.

But her mother never said that the Gu family was a cage that devoured people without spitting out bones.

Gu Chunmian's mother was still alive, and every time she saw her, she looked as if she wanted to kill her.

Just being stared at by those eyes made Gu Yixue feel she couldn't eat.

Sometimes, she felt disgusted with herself.

Probably because she entered this industry, her ability to immerse herself was much stronger than others.

She would occasionally think, if she were Gu Chunmian's mother, what would she do?

Perhaps every day she spent in the Gu family, Mrs. Gu felt as if there was a fishbone stuck in her throat.

Even though she tried her best to yield to Gu Chunmian, and when young had carefully tried to please Gu Chunmian.

She never received a pleasant expression.

So at sixteen, she went abroad to study, and almost only returned once a year.

If possible, she wouldn't return even once.

Those days abroad were quite pleasant. Everyone only knew her as Quella, not as Gu Yixue.

Not as that illegitimate daughter of the Gu family who couldn't see the light.

Even so, the friends she made abroad were merely casual acquaintances.

Some became acquainted through talent, some through spending time together.

But when she returned to the country, she basically lost contact with them all.

However, Gu Yixue still came back today.

This was the second year of her marriage to Shen Fenghe, and the first birthday she was spending.

In previous years, she would occasionally receive a birthday greeting from Shen Fenghe right on time or late.

She didn't know if there would be one this year.

Gu Yixue often wondered, are people moths?

How could they keep doing things like flying into flames?

And enjoy it endlessly.

At least she was.

When it came to Shen Fenghe, she was willing to be a moth.

But reality still disappointed Gu Yixue.

Though the lights at home were on, it was the live-in housekeeper auntie, a deaf-mute person. She had just finished making a meal and was dozing at the dining table. Seeing Gu Yixue return, she immediately stood up and moved aside, then rubbed her eyes. After coming to her senses, she anxiously communicated with Gu Yixue in sign language: "Have you eaten? Let me heat it up for you."

Gu Yixue also replied in sign language: [No need, I'm tired, you should rest early.]

For Gu Yixue and Shen Fenghe, employing a deaf-mute auntie wasn't inconvenient.

Because both she and Shen Fenghe knew sign language.

The reason was that when she was twelve, she went out with Gu Chunmian, and Gu Chunmian seemed to be making a bet with friends. She used a slingshot to shoot directly at her, hitting her ear bone.

Because her ear couldn't hear, she was also unwilling to communicate with people.

She became a deaf-mute for a very long time.

During that time, Shen Fenghe often came to see her, often took her out to play.

And learned sign language.

Shen Fenghe was someone who learned everything very quickly.

Gu Chunmian really disliked Shen Fenghe playing with her, but Shen Fenghe had a strong personality and was equally cold to everyone. Even though Gu Chunmian might be her fiancée, she never listened to Gu Chunmian.

This was also one of the reasons Gu Chunmian disliked Shen Fenghe.

Footnotes:

¹ 争 or 抢 (zhēng or qiǎng) - To compete or fight for something; the phrase means to live without 争ing (competing/争ling) or 抢ing (snatching/fighting for things)

Chapter 190 - Part 2

Extra 12-2

After Gu Yixue finished talking with the auntie, she went back to her room to shower. When she came out after showering, it was already 11:40. She casually applied body lotion while sitting around bored in a daze.

Clearly, Shen Fenghe hadn't come back yet.

And her phone hadn't rung either, so Shen Fenghe had even forgotten her birthday.

Gu Yixue glanced at her phone. Many were messages from staff and actors. She opened them one by one to look, but didn't reply to anyone.

After applying body lotion, the air filled with a faint jasmine fragrance.

She didn't care that her hair was still wet and leaned against the bed, lowering her head to play a little game, trying to keep her heart from being so affected.

But at times like this, little games couldn't distract Gu Yixue's attention either.

After playing one round, Gu Yixue sat by the bay window again to look at the moon.

Her birthday was close to the fifteenth, so the moon was very round.

Not knowing what she was thinking about, she slowly felt drowsy.

Over these years, Gu Yixue's life hadn't been easy. Walking on thin ice in the Gu family, there were several times in her sleep when Gu Chunmian nearly smothered her to death, so her sleep was very light.

The moment someone touched her, she would wake up.

When she woke up, she happened to grab a slender wrist. Even though her eyes couldn't quite open yet, her hand had already applied force, so she heard a familiar muffled groan.

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Gu Yixue fully woke up.

She sat up and pinched the bridge of her nose, discovering an extra blanket on her body that hadn't been properly covered yet.

Gu Yixue asked hoarsely: "Why did you come back?"

Shen Fenghe raised an eyebrow: "Can't I come back to my own home?"

Gu Yixue paused: "I didn't mean that."

"Oh." Shen Fenghe said.

Shen Fenghe had never been afraid of awkwardness.

She always had the ability to adjust the atmosphere to its most awkward state.

At this moment, the room fell silent. Gu Yixue was still a bit dazed. Her hair was half-dry. She casually grabbed at it and actually pulled out a strand of hair.

That long strand lay alone in her palm, divided into two very distinct color tones.

It had been a long time since she'd dyed her hair. Gu Yixue thought.

Gu Yixue sat there, beginning to regret why she came back.

She shouldn't have had expectations.

The higher the expectations, the greater the disappointment.

Usually it didn't matter if she took more initiative, but on days like this, she kept a selfish hope that just for this one day, Shen Fenghe would be a little better to her, and then she could continue burning herself out.

"Did you eat?" Shen Fenghe asked first.

Gu Yixue shook her head: "No."

A few minutes passed, and Gu Yixue finally became somewhat more clear-headed.

She stood up and looked at Shen Fenghe, really wanting to hug her.

Thinking this, she did it.

One good thing about marrying Shen Fenghe was that she wouldn't resist her approaches like before.

Gu Yixue could hug her, could kiss her. When in bed, they were also uninhibited.

Gu Yixue would deliberately use a very tender voice to call her elder sister, sometimes even boldly calling: "Shen Fenghe."

Enunciating each word clearly.

Shen Fenghe would pause.

In her impression, Gu Yixue had always been someone who obediently called her elder sister.

So Gu Yixue calling her elder sister was perfectly normal.

But suddenly calling her by name, Shen Fenghe felt somewhat awkward, so she would pinch her waist, leaving obvious red marks on that beautiful waistline, "Not good."

Gu Yixue especially loved wearing crop tops.

Her waistline was often exposed.

Her closet was full of this type of clothing.

And her waist was indeed beautiful.

But after marrying Shen Fenghe, Gu Yixue's closet gained many oversized clothes, in a style completely different from her usual one.

Shen Fenghe liked them.

Especially because she wanted her to wear oversized clothes, she would deliberately leave marks on her waist during their intimate moments that wouldn't fade.

Maybe by the next time they were intimate, the marks still hadn't completely faded.

Gu Yixue didn't mind though.

On the contrary, she really liked it.

She always had to find evidence in these small details to prove that Shen Fenghe cared about her.

Even if it wasn't love, it was at least caring.

Chapter 190 - Part 3

Extra 12-3

Gu Yixue rested her head on Shen Fenghe's shoulder. Shen Fenghe's body first stiffened, then she hugged her back, asking in a low voice: "Did someone bully you?"

Gu Yixue shook her head: "No."

Shen Fenghe was about to ask more, but Gu Yixue answered first: "A bit tired."

So Shen Fenghe stood there quietly.

After hugging for a while, Gu Yixue asked: "Have you eaten? Should we order takeout?"

"I bought some." Shen Fenghe said.

"Okay."

As Gu Yixue spoke, she walked out, but after taking one step, she stepped back, holding Shen Fenghe's hand and sliding her fingers between hers.

Intertwining their fingers.

Gu Yixue really liked the position of intertwined fingers. To her, this entangled connection was the most intimate thing.

When they reached the dining room, Gu Yixue discovered an extra cake on the dining table.

Gu Yixue looked at Shen Fenghe.

Shen Fenghe seemed somewhat awkward as she said: "Happy birthday."

Gu Yixue raised her hand to check her watch—it was already past midnight.

Her birthday had already ended.

Shen Fenghe always seemed to be like this. In her world, she was always late.

But she always came.

From childhood to now, every time was like this.

Shen Fenghe lit the candles for her, then watched as she pressed her palms together to make a wish and blow them out.

The two shared the cake.

The atmosphere while eating was also quiet.

Gu Yixue didn't really like sweets, but tonight she ate the cake clean, eating until she felt nauseated from the sweetness.

Before bed, Shen Fenghe went to shower. Gu Yixue held her phone looking at footage from the day's filming.

When Shen Fenghe came out, Gu Yixue put down her phone and scooted toward her, focusing intently on Shen Fenghe.

Shen Fenghe's brows furrowed slightly: "What are you looking at me for?"

Gu Yixue pressed her lips together: "Because you're beautiful."

Shen Fenghe propped her arms on the bed, staring straight at her.

Their eyes met.

Shen Fenghe slowly leaned down, moving close to Gu Yixue. Gu Yixue raised herself up to kiss her.

The moment their lips met, Gu Yixue bit her lip.

Gu Yixue said: "You were late."

Shen Fenghe thought she was talking about being three minutes late from the shower, so she pressed her body down, her voice cold: "I'll be earlier next time."

At that moment, Gu Yixue thought, hopefully so.

But she didn't expect that Shen Fenghe would truly continue being late throughout her life.

And she just happened to only love this one person.

But later Gu Yixue thought, perhaps if there was no late Shen Fenghe, then there wouldn't have been Gu Yixue's later life either.

Shen Fenghe was just late. Others never arrived at all.